

Cairnkeepers

A Guide's field book: rules, callings, and what lives above the snowline

Property of the Cairnkeepers' Guild, Brennford. If found on the mountain, follow the cairns down and hand it in at the guildhouse.

Cairnkeepers' Guild

Cairnkeepers — Rules

A game of rope, weather and the safe way through, for a GM and 2–5 players.

1. THE WHITECROWN

For three hundred years the guild of **Cairnkeepers** has walked travellers over the Whitecrown pass. Above the treeline there is no road, only snow, and the way is marked by **cairns**: stone piles a little taller than a man, one in sight of the next. A Cairnkeeper keeps them standing, reads the weather, carries the rope, and brings people down alive.

This winter came early. Cairns that stood for a century have been found knocked flat, or moved, leading onto thin ice and over edges. The guild says it is the Rimehands, the wreckers who loot what the mountain takes. The old guides say something else moves the stones, and that it has always lived up there, under the ice, waiting for the cairns to fall.

You play **Guides** of the guild. You go up when nobody else will.

What the game is about. Two things decide every scene: **the ground** (where you can stand, how fast you move, what gives way under you) and **what you can see** (the weather, the rock in the way, the white that hides the wolves). Both are on the board, and the board enforces them.

2. DICE

Everything is rolled on **2d6**, plus one of your four **traits**.

TRAIT	WHAT IT COVERS
Grit	Strength, endurance, cold, carrying, hitting hard
Footing	Balance, climbing, ice, quick hands, getting out of the way
Sense	Spotting, tracking, reading the weather, aiming
Lore	Rope-work, medicine, the old ways, the Stonespeakers' arts

A trait runs from −1 to +3.

2.1 Checks

When the outcome is in doubt and failing would matter, roll **2d6 + trait** against a target:

TARGET	
8	Standard. A trained Guide makes this more often than not.
10	Hard.
12	Extreme. Only the best, with help.

Meet or beat it and you succeed. A roll of **2** (double ones) always fails; a roll of **12** (double sixes) always succeeds.

Knacks. Each Guide has two Knacks, things they are trained in: *Climbing, Ropework, Tracking, Weather-wise, Medicine, Stealth, Cairn-lore, Hauling, Ice-craft, Hunting, Cooking, Haggling.* A Knack that applies adds **+1**.

Edge and Snag. Something in your favour (high ground, a Mark, a good plan, help from an ally) is an **Edge**, +1. Something against you (cover, the wind, a bad footing) is a **Snag**, −1. They stack up to ±2 and cancel each other. The GM calls them.

On the board. Players roll their own checks in the Dice panel (`2d6+2`). For attacks, the GM folds Edge and Snag into the hit-or-miss ruling, so nobody re-rolls.

2.2 Saves

When something happens *to* you (an avalanche, a breath of killing cold) you **save**: 2d6 + the trait named, against the effect's difficulty (**DC**), usually 8 or 10. Many effects do half damage on a save.

On the board. A save against an area is an **area effect**: the GM places the template, starts an Area Effect with the expression `2d6`, and the server rolls it for every token caught. The GM adds each one's trait, then marks each target **Full** or **Half**.

3. MAKING A GUIDE

1. **Choose a calling** (§9): Pathfinder, Hauler, Hunter or Stonespeaker.
2. **Assign traits**: +2, +1, 0, 0 in any order, then add your calling's +1. No trait may start above +3.
3. **Choose a background** and take its Knack, then choose one more Knack:

BACKGROUND	KNACK
Guild-born	Cairn-lore
Salt-trader	Haggling
Hill farmer	Hauling
Reformed Rimehand	Stealth
Hospice orphan	Medicine
Surveyor's apprentice	Weather-wise

4. **Work out your numbers**: HP from your calling; **Guard** = 7 + Footing + armour (heavy coat +1; a shield +1); **Move** 6 squares.
5. **Take your gear** (§9 and §10), your rope, and two bonds: a short sentence about another Guide.

4. THE GROUND

The board is divided into 5 ft squares. Every square is one of three kinds of ground, and the board itself knows which.

GROUND	ON THE BOARD	WHAT IT IS UP HERE	MOVING
Normal	nothing painted	packed trail, rock floor, boards, safe ice	1 square per square
Difficult	painted Difficult	deep snow, scree, brush, streams, thin ice, drifts, meltwater	**2** squares per square
Blocked	painted Blocked	crevasses, gorges, open water, chasms, rubble	can't be entered

Rock, cliffs and walls are walls on the map: you can't move through them *and* you can't see through them.

On the board. The GM's **Terrain** filter shows the painted ground. The movement ruler counts Difficult squares double, so a Guide with Move 6 can cross three squares of deep snow. The server refuses a move into Blocked ground or through a wall. Players see the ground only where they can see.

4.1 Bad footing

- **Ice and scree.** If you **Dash** across thin ice or scree, roll **Footing 8**. Fail and you stop where you are, **Prone**.
- **Prone.** Standing up costs half your Move (3 squares). Attacks against a Prone creature next to it have Edge; from farther away, Snag.
- **Shoved off.** A creature pushed into a crevasse, gorge or open water saves **Footing 8** to catch the edge: it stops in the last square before the drop, **Prone**. On a failure it falls: **2d6** damage and it's out of the scene, hanging on the rope or under the ice, until someone hauls it out (an Action and **Grit 10**, or Grit 8 with a rope already on it). A creature that falls into open water is also **Restrained** and takes **1d6** cold at the start of each of its turns until it's out.

4.2 Rope

Guides carry 50 ft of rope each.

- **Roped together.** Guides who rope up move at the pace of the slowest of them and must end each turn within 2 squares of the next one on the rope. In return, none of them rolls Footing for bad ground, and a roped Guide who would fall is caught by the next one on the rope: the catcher saves **Grit 8**, and on a success nobody falls.
- **Fixing a line** across a gap of up to 3 squares (a crevasse, a stream) takes 10 minutes out of combat and a **Ropework** or **Lore 8** check. Then anyone can cross it at a cost of 2 squares per square.

> **On the board.** A fixed line is a GM call: drag the token across. The ruler still shows the gap as Blocked.

4.3 Temporary ground

The mountain changes. When the snow slides or the ice breaks, the GM paints the change on the board as a **temporary terrain effect** with a name, and removes it when it clears.

EFFECT	GROUND	WHERE IT COMES FROM
Avalanche	Blocked where the snow piles, Difficult at its edges	the Storm Clock, loud noise, the adventure
Rockfall	Blocked	the Cairn-Taker, the Switchbacks
Cracking ice	Blocked (holes)	weight on thin ice; spreads each round
Snowdrift	Difficult, or Blocked across a door	wind; the Hospice
Ice Wall	Blocked, and you can see through it	the Stonespeaker's art
Churned snow	Difficult	the Stonespeaker's art

> **On the board. Paint terrain → New effect**, name it, paint the squares. Effects sit on top of the map's own ground: Blocked wins, and Difficult never stacks past double. Remove the effect when it ends.

5. SIGHT

You can only fight what you can see, and up here the mountain decides how far that is.

5.1 Weather sets the distance

At the start of each **watch** (a quarter of a day), the GM rolls **2d6** and adds one for each filled segment of the **Storm Clock** (§7):

ROLL	WEATHER	HOW FAR YOU CAN SEE
2–6	**Clear**	as far as the map goes
7–8	**Haze**	60 ft (12 squares)
9–10	**Snowfall**	30 ft (6 squares)
11–12	**Squall**	15 ft (3 squares)
13+	**Whiteout**	10 ft (2 squares)

Underground or at night, it's how far your light reaches: a storm lantern **30 ft**, a torch **20 ft**, nothing at all **5 ft**.

In **Snowfall** and worse, ranged attacks at more than 6 squares have a Snag. In a **Whiteout**, every Sense check has a Snag.

> **On the board.** Turn **line of sight** on for every scene (**Manage → Edit map → Sight**) and set the **sight range** to the weather in feet. Clear means no range. When the weather turns, change the range: every player's view changes at once.

5.2 What's in the way

- **Rock, cliffs and walls** block sight completely.
- **Doors** block sight while closed.
- **Ice** — ice walls, frozen falls, pressure ridges on a lake — is clear. You can see through it, but you can't pass it.
- **Obscuring ground** (pine stands, steam from the hot springs underground): nobody outside it can see into it, and from inside you see out. A Guide hidden in the pines is invisible to everything outside them.
- **Partial cover** (a boulder or a half wall between you and the target, but not all the way): Snag on the attack.

> **On the board.** Rock and walls are the map's walls. Ice is imported as **locked windows**: windows never block sight, and players can't open a locked one. Obscuring ground is **fog**: fog blocks sight from outside, and a token standing in a fog region sees out of it. Hidden foes and players' sight are handled by the server; nobody's screen shows what their tokens can't see.

5.3 Spotting and hiding

- Foes the Guides haven't seen are **hidden tokens**. A foe that moves into a Guide's sight is spotted: the GM reveals it.
- Some things lie still in the snow (white-coat wolves, a Hunter in her white hide). Coming into sight isn't enough: a Guide who looks rolls **Sense 8** (Snag in Snowfall or worse). On a success the GM reveals it.
- **Hiding** takes an Action, somewhere no foe can see you, in snow, scrub or shadow, and a **Footing 8** roll (Stealth applies). You stay hidden until you attack, shout or move into the open.

> **On the board.** A hidden creature's token is **Hidden** (players can't see it) and carries the **Invisible** condition. Reveal it by unticking Hidden.

5.4 Cairns

A standing cairn is a mark on the safe way, and a raised one pushes the white back.

- **Raising a cairn** (restacking a fallen one) takes an **Action** and **Lore 8** (Cairn-lore applies; Snag in a Whiteout).

- While the Guides are within 6 squares of a raised cairn, the weather counts one step better for them (Whiteout becomes Squall, Squall becomes Snowfall, and so on).
- Some things up here hate a raised cairn (see the bestiary).

> **On the board.** Cairns are tokens with two pictures: **Cairn (fallen)** and **Cairn (raised)**. Raise one by changing its image. When the Guides are near a raised cairn, set the sight range one step better.

6. COMBAT

6.1 Order

When a fight starts, everyone rolls **2d6 + Footing** for initiative. Foes use their listed initiative. Highest goes first.

> **On the board. Start encounter** and type each score. For a pack of wolves, select their group and give them one score.

6.2 Your turn

On your turn you have:

- a **Move** of 6 squares, paid at the ground's cost;
- an **Action**: attack, Dash (move again), use an art, raise a cairn, haul someone out, help, hide, search;
- a **Quick action**: draw or stow, open or close a door, drink, Mark, call out;
- and once per round, a **Reaction** on someone else's turn, if something gives you one.

6.3 Attacking

Roll **2d6 + trait** against the target's **Guard**:

- **melee** with Grit, or Footing for a light weapon (ice axe, knife, spear);
- **ranged** with Sense;
- **arts** with Lore.

From level 3, add +1 to every attack.

On a hit, roll the weapon's damage and add the same trait. A **12** on the dice hits whatever the Guard and adds one more damage die. A **2** misses.

WEAPON	DAMAGE	NOTES
Knife	1d4	light, can be thrown 4 squares
Ice axe	1d6	light; Edge on climbing
Hatchet	1d6	can be thrown 4 squares
Spear	1d6	light, reach 2 squares
Mattock	1d8	two hands
Sling	1d4	range 10 squares
Bow	1d8	two hands, range 16 squares
Crossbow	1d8	range 12 squares, an Action to reload

> **On the board.** Each Guide's token carries their weapons and arts as **named attacks**, with the dice already in them (`2d6+3` to hit, `1d6+3` damage). Roll from the token; the GM rules the hit against the target's AC (its Guard) and applies the damage.

6.4 Down in the snow

At **0 HP** you drop, **Unconscious**. At the start of each of your turns, roll **2d6**:

- **2–6:** mark a **Frost**. At three Frost, the mountain takes you.
- **7–11:** you hold on.
- **12:** you come round with 1 HP.

An ally next to you can **Haul Out** (an Action and **Lore 8**, Medicine applies): you stop rolling and wake with 1 HP. Any healing does the same. Frost marks clear after a long rest.

7. WARMTH AND THE STORM CLOCK

Warmth is the party's shared reserve of heat, food and dry socks: **10**.

- Each **watch** outdoors costs **1 Warmth**, or **2** in a Squall or Whiteout. A watch indoors beside a fire costs nothing.
- A **short rest** (an hour out of the wind) costs **1 Warmth**.
- A fire at the hospice or the guildhouse refills it.
- At **0 Warmth**, everyone has a Snag on every check, and at the end of each watch every Guide takes **1d6** cold.

The **Storm Clock** is the GM's: six segments that fill as the weather closes in.

- One segment at the end of every watch outdoors.
- One for noise: a shout across a slope, a crossbow volley, a rockfall.
- One when a check fails and the GM says the mountain noticed.

Each filled segment adds 1 to the weather roll. **At six**, the pass closes: Whiteout for the rest of the day, and an avalanche wherever the GM likes.

> **On the board.** Two tokens with an HP bar: **Warmth** (10/10), where everyone can see it, and the **Storm Clock** (0/6), **hidden**. Change their HP as they go up and down.

8. REST AND ADVANCEMENT

- **Short rest:** an hour, 1 Warmth. Recover half your HP (round up) and your arts' Stones.
- **Long rest:** a night at the hospice or the guildhouse. Recover everything; clear Frost.

LEVEL	WHEN	YOU GAIN
2	a rescue made	HP (your calling's step), one new art
3	a second rescue	+1 to a trait (max +4), +1 to all attacks
4	the pass made safe	HP (your calling's step), one new art

9. CALLINGS

9.1 Pathfinder

You read the snow. You go first, and you find the way the others can follow.

- **+1 Footing.** HP **10 + 2 × Grit**, +4 a level.
- **Gear:** ice axe, sling, spyglass, rope, crampons.
- **Feature — Read the Weather.** Once per watch, before the GM rolls the weather, roll **Sense 8**. On a success the GM rolls twice and you choose.
- **Arts:**
  - **Mark** (*Quick*). A foe you can see is marked until the start of your next turn. Everyone has Edge against it.
  - **Spyglass** (*Action*). Roll **Sense 8**. On a success the GM reveals every hidden creature in your line of sight, even past the sight range.
  - **Find the Line** (*Action*). Name a path of up to 6 squares through Difficult ground. Until your next turn, the Guides who follow it pay Normal cost.
- **Level 2 (choose one):** *Sure-foot* — you never roll for bad footing. *Long Sight* — the weather counts one step better for you alone.
- **Level 4 (choose one):** *Lead the Rope* — roped Guides move at your pace. *Call the Gap* — once per scene, one Guide who would fall doesn't.

> **On the board.** Named attacks: *Ice axe* (to-hit `2d6 + Footing`, damage `1d6 + Footing`), *Sling* (`2d6 + Sense`, `1d4 + Sense`).

9.2 Hauler

You carry the camp, hold the rope and stand where the wind is worst.

- **+1 Grit.** HP **14 + 2 × Grit**, +6 a level.
- **Gear:** mattock, heavy coat (+1 Guard), the camp kettle, 100 ft of rope, a shield of lashed boards (+1 Guard).
- **Feature — Packhorse.** The party's Warmth is **12** while you're with it.
- **Arts:**
  - **Shove** (*Action*). A melee attack with no damage. On a hit, push the target 1 square, or 2 if it's smaller than you. Into a crevasse, it saves to catch the edge (§4.1).
  - **Anchor** (*Action*). Throw a loop of rope: a melee attack with no damage, reach 2. On a hit the target is **Restrained** until it breaks free (**Grit 10**, its Action).
  - **Belay** (*Reaction*). An ally within 3 squares who would fall doesn't.
- **Level 2 (choose one):** *Brace* — while you don't move, foes can't push you or the ally beside you. *Second Wind* — once per rest, regain 1d6 + Grit HP as a Quick action.
- **Level 4 (choose one):** *Dig In* — Difficult ground costs you nothing extra. *Haul* — Haul Out is a Quick action for you.

> **On the board.** Named attacks: *Mattock* (`2d6 + Grit`, `1d8 + Grit`), *Shove* and *Anchor* (to-hit only).

9.3 Hunter

You feed the camp and keep the wolves honest. They never see you first.

- **+1 Sense.** HP **10 + 2 × Grit**, +5 a level.
- **Gear:** bow, spear, white hide cloak, snares, knife.
- **Feature — Ambush.** When you attack a creature that couldn't see you, add **1d6** damage.
- **Arts:**
  - **White Hide** (*Action*). In snow or scrub, where no foe can see you: you're hidden, no roll.
  - **Twin Shot** (*Action*). Two arrows at two targets, each with a Snag.
  - **Snare** (*Action*). A ranged attack with no damage, range 6. On a hit the target is **Restrained** until it frees itself (**Footing 10**, its Action).
- **Level 2 (choose one):** *Tracker* — Edge on every Sense check to follow tracks; *Patient* — while hidden you can attack once without being revealed.
- **Level 4 (choose one):** *Heartshot* — Ambush adds 2d6; *Hunter's Mark* — your Mark lasts the whole scene (you learn Mark).

> **On the board.** Named attacks: *Bow* (`2d6 + Sense`, `1d8 + Sense`), *Twin Shot* (`2d6 + Sense − 1`, `1d8 + Sense`, **up to 2 targets**), *Spear*, *Snare* (to-hit only), *Ambush* (damage `1d6` only).

9.4 Stonespeaker

The old stones listen to you. You ask the ice to move, and sometimes it does.

- **+1 Lore.** HP **8 + 2 × Grit**, +4 a level.
- **Gear:** staff, a pouch of cairn-stones, a hearth-stone that stays warm.
- **Stones.** You have **3 Stones**. An art with a cost spends them. They come back after a rest.
- **Arts** (the Art DC is **7 + Lore**):
  - **Stone Fist** (*Action*, free). A ranged attack, range 8: `2d6 + Lore`, `1d6 + Lore`.
  - **Rime Lash** (*Action*, 1 Stone). A 15 ft cone of killing cold. Everyone in it saves **Grit** against your Art DC: **2d6** damage, half on a save.
  - **Ice Wall** (*Action*, 1 Stone). Raise a wall of clear ice up to 4 squares long, in a straight line, within 6 squares. Nothing passes it; everyone sees through it. It lasts the scene, or until it takes 10 damage.
  - **Churn the Snow** (*Action*, 1 Stone). A 3 × 3 area within 8 squares becomes deep snow (Difficult) for the scene.
  - **Cairnsong** (*Action*, 1 Stone). One Guide within 6 squares regains **1d6 + Lore** HP. Beside a raised cairn, every Guide within 2 squares of it does.
- **Level 2 (choose one):** *Deep Stones* — 4 Stones. *Hold the Ice* — keep an Ice Wall or Churn going into the next scene (you're **Concentrating**).
- **Level 4 (choose one):** *Avalanche Call* — once per day, 2 Stones: a 2 × 6 area becomes an avalanche (§4.3); everyone in it saves **Footing** against your Art DC or takes **2d6** and is **Restrained**. *Stone Ward* — when an ally within 6 squares is hit, spend 1 Stone to give them +2 Guard against it.

> **On the board.** Named attacks: *Stone Fist*, *Rime Lash* (damage `2d6` only), *Cairnsong* (damage `1d6 + Lore` only: apply it as healing). For **Ice Wall** and **Churn the Snow**, the GM paints a temporary effect (§4.3) with that name.

10. GEAR

Everyone carries: rope (50 ft), a storm lantern, a bedroll, crampons, three days' food, flint and steel, a tin cup. Your calling adds the rest.

ITEM	USE
Storm lantern	light to 30 ft underground or at night
Crampons	Edge on Footing checks on ice
Spyglass	the Pathfinder's art; anyone else, Edge on Sense at long range
Snow-goggles	ignore the Snag from Snowfall on Sense checks
Tonic of hot gin	regain 1d6 HP, Quick action, 2 in the camp kettle

11. CONDITIONS

The board's conditions, with what they mean up here. Charmed and Paralyzed don't come up.

CONDITION	UP HERE	EFFECT
Blinded	snow-blind	You can't see; attacks you make have Snag 2, attacks against you Edge
Frightened	shaken	Snag on attacks and checks while the cause is in sight
Grappled	held	Your Move is 0
Restrained	snowbound, roped, snared	Move 0; Snag on attacks; attacks against you have Edge
Prone	lost footing	§4.1
Invisible	white on white	Hidden: see §5.3
Poisoned	frost-sick	Snag on every check
Stunned	winded	No Action or Reaction, half Move, until the end of your next turn
Unconscious	down	§6.4
Concentrating	holding an art	When you take damage, save **Grit 8** or the art ends

12. FOR THE GM

12.1 Running the mountain

Each scene, decide three things before the Guides arrive, and set them on the board:

1. **The ground.** The map's own ground is painted already if you set the game up with the setup script; check it with the Terrain filter.
2. **The weather.** Roll it, and set the sight range.
3. **What waits, and where.** Hidden tokens for whatever hasn't been seen yet.

Then let the board do the work. Deep snow slows everyone, the ruler shows it, and the Guides will start choosing their ground before you ask them to.

12.2 Threat

FOE	THREAT
White-coat, Scree goat, Rimehand	1
Ice-crawler swarm	2

FOE	THREAT
Kettle Varga	4
The Cairn-Taker	10

For four level-1 Guides: **4** is a fair fight, **6** a hard one, **9** a deadly one. Add 2 at level 2. Bad ground and bad weather count for more than numbers: four wolves in a Whiteout are a deadly fight.

12.3 Making it fair

- **Say what the ground is** before anyone moves onto it. Guides should die of their choices, not of a square they didn't know was thin ice.
- **Telegraph the mountain.** Before an avalanche or a rockfall, there's a sound. Give the Guides a round to react.
- **Let them use it.** A Hauler who shoves a Rimehand into a crevasse has won the fight; let them.

13. BESTIARY

The foes, the hospice's keeper and the board pieces are in the next part of this book, each with a **platform entry** to type into a library creature.

Cairnkeepers — Bestiary

Every foe ends with a **platform entry**: the values to type into a **library creature** (Library → Creatures → New creature), so placing one puts its HP, Guard and attacks on the board at once.

- **AC** on the board is the creature's **Guard**.
- **Attacks** are written as the attack editor takes them: to-hit `count d sides + modifier` and damage `count d sides + modifier`. "—" means that roll is left empty.
- **Token art** is the name of the token image to use.
- **Initiative** is fixed: type it as the creature's score when the encounter starts.

Save modifiers are listed as **G / F / S / L** (Grit, Footing, Sense, Lore).

WHITE-COAT

A mountain wolf in its winter coat, white to the skin. It lies down in the snow and waits for the weather to bring something to it.

Size 1 · **HP** 7 · **Guard** 9 · **Move** 8 · **Initiative** 8 · **Saves** +1 / +2 / +2 / −1 · **Threat** 1

- **Bite.** +2 to hit, **1d6+1**.
- **Pack.** Edge on its bite when another white-coat is next to the target.
- **Pull Down.** When its attack roll totals 11 or more, the target is also **Prone**.
- **Snow-runner.** Deep snow costs it nothing extra.
- **Lies Still.** While it doesn't move, it's hidden in snow: coming into sight isn't enough to see it; a Guide must spot it (**Sense 8**).

Tactics. Wait in a line across the trail, downwind. Rise together when the first Guide is two squares away, go for whoever is alone, and run when half the pack is down.

PLATFORM ENTRY	
Name	White-coat
Size	1
Max HP	7
AC	9
Colour	`#b9c7d3`
Attacks	**Bite** — to-hit `2d6+2`, damage `1d6+1`
Token art	White-coat
Starting conditions	Invisible (remove when it's spotted)

SCREE GOAT

Shaggy, yellow-eyed, and completely at home on ground that kills people. It doesn't want to fight. It wants you off its ledge.

Size 1 · **HP** 8 · **Guard** 9 · **Move** 8 · **Initiative** 9 · **Saves** +2 / +3 / +1 / −1 · **Threat** 1

- **Butt.** +3 to hit, **1d6+1**, and the target is pushed 1 square. Pushed into a gorge or a crevasse, it saves to catch the edge.
- **Sure-footed.** No ground is Difficult for it.

Tactics. Ignore the Guides until one comes within 2 squares, then butt them toward the nearest edge and bound away.

PLATFORM ENTRY	
Name	Scree Goat
Size	1
Max HP	8
AC	9
Colour	`#c8b48a`
Attacks	**Butt** — to-hit `2d6+3`, damage `1d6+1`
Token art	Scree Goat

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RIMEHAND

A wrecker in a patched fur coat and a scarf over the mouth. Rimehands knock down cairns, wait for travellers to walk off the safe way, and loot what's left.

Size 1 · **HP** 8 · **Guard** 9 · **Move** 6 · **Initiative** 7 · **Saves** +1 / +1 / +1 / 0 · **Threat** 1

- **Hatchet.** +2 to hit, **1d6+1**. Can be thrown 4 squares.
- **Crossbow.** +2 to hit, range 12, **1d8**. It takes an Action to reload.
- **Know the Ice.** Rimehands roll **Footing** for bad ground with an Edge.

Tactics. Shoot from behind rock, close in on whoever falls. Each one runs when it drops to 3 HP or less, and all of them run when Kettle Varga goes down.

PLATFORM ENTRY	
Name	Rimehand
Size	1
Max HP	8
AC	9
Colour	`#6b4a33`
Attacks	**Hatchet** — to-hit `2d6+2`, damage `1d6+1` · **Crossbow** — to-hit `2d6+2`, damage `1d8+0`
Token art	Rimehand

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KETTLE VARGA

The Rimehands' boss: broad, patient, and polite, with an iron hook-axe and a kettle of smoking pitch. She has been paying something in the ice to move the cairns. She's starting to regret it.

Size 1 · **HP** 18 · **Guard** 10 · **Move** 6 · **Initiative** 9 · **Saves** +2 / +1 / +2 / +1 · **Threat** 4

- **Hook-axe.** +3 to hit, **1d8+2**. On a hit she may pull the target 1 square toward her.
- **Smoke Kettle** (once). She throws the kettle: everyone within 2 squares of the point saves **Grit 9** or is **Blinded** until the end of their next turn. The smoke is obscuring until the end of the round.
- **Talk First.** If the Guides talk before they fight, she'll trade the hospice for her crew's lives. At 6 HP or less she surrenders and tells what she knows (adventure, scene 3).

Tactics. Keep the Guides at the hall's doors while her crossbows shoot. Kettle when two Guides stand together.

PLATFORM ENTRY

Name	Kettle Varga
Size	1
Max HP	18
AC	10
Colour	`#8a3b1f`
Attacks	**Hook-axe** — to-hit `2d6+3`, damage `1d8+2`
Token art	Kettle Varga

On the board. For the Smoke Kettle, place a 2-square circle, start an **Area Effect** with the expression `2d6`, and add **Blinded** to each target that fails. Then lay a fog region over the circle until the end of the round.

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ICE-CRAWLER SWARM

Pale, many-legged things the length of a finger, by the hundred. They live inside the ice and come out of it like water.

Size 1 · **HP** 10 · **Guard** 8 · **Move** 6 · **Initiative** 8 · **Saves** –1 / +2 / 0 / –2 · **Threat** 2

- **Bites.** +2 to hit, **2d4**, against **up to 2** creatures next to it.
- **Through the Ice.** It moves through ice walls and ice as if they weren't there.
- **Fire.** It takes double damage from fire, and won't come within 1 square of a lit lantern set down on the ground.

PLATFORM ENTRY

Name	Ice-crawler Swarm
Size	1
Max HP	10
AC	8
Colour	`#7fb4d1`
Attacks	**Bites** — to-hit `2d6+2`, damage `2d4+0`, **max targets 2**
Token art	Ice-crawlers

On the board. Moving through ice is a GM drag: the server lets the GM place a token anywhere.

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THE CAIRN-TAKER

What moves the stones. A hunched shape of rock and old ice the size of a cart, with cairn-stones grown into its back like barnacles. It doesn't eat people. It eats the way: *every cairn it carries off is a road nobody can find again.*

Size 3 · **HP** 34 · **Guard** 10 · **Move** 4 · **Initiative** 8 · **Saves** +4 / 0 / +2 / +2 · **Threat** 10

- **Stone Fists.** +4 to hit, **1d8+2**, against **up to 2** creatures within 2 squares.
- **Whiteout Breath.** At the start of its turn, roll a d6: on **5–6** it breathes a 15 ft cone. Everyone in it saves **Grit 10**: **2d6** cold, half on a save. Until its next turn, the sight range in the cave is **10 ft.**
- **Pull the Roof** (instead of its Fists, once per round). Three squares in a line within 8 squares of it come down: everyone there saves **Footing 9** or takes **1d8+2** and is **Prone**. The squares are **Blocked** for the rest of the scene.
- **Cairn-bound.** When a Guide raises a cairn within 6 squares of it, it's **Stunned** until the end of its next turn. When all three cairns in its den stand, its Guard drops to **8** and it can no longer breathe.

Tactics. Stay in the dark at the back of the den, let the Guides come through the ice maze, and bring the roof down behind them. Go for whoever is raising a cairn.

PLATFORM ENTRY

Name	The Cairn-Taker
Size	3
Max HP	34
AC	10
Colour	`#46525e`
Attacks	**Stone Fists** — to-hit `2d6+4`, damage `1d8+2`, **max targets 2** · **Whiteout Breath** — to-hit —, damage `2d6+0`
Token art	The Cairn-Taker

On the board. Whiteout Breath is a cone and an **Area Effect** (`2d6` saves), then **sight range 10 ft** until its next turn. **Pull the Roof** paints a temporary effect named **Rockfall** (§4.3 of the rules).

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BROTHER ALDRIC

The last brother of the Hospice of St. Brenn: seventy, deaf in one ear, and entirely unafraid. He knows the caves under the hospice, and he knows what's down there.

Size 1 · **HP** 10 · **Guard** 8 · **Move** 5 · **Initiative** 5

- **Hot Broth.** A Guide next to him regains **1d6+2** HP (an Action; three bowls a day).
- **The Way Down.** He knows the safe path through the ice caves: with him, the Guides roll Footing for bad ground there with an Edge.

PLATFORM ENTRY

Name	Brother Aldric
Size	1

PLATFORM ENTRY	
Max HP	10
AC	8
Colour	`#a8562a`
Attacks	**Hot Broth** — to-hit —, damage `1d6+2` (a heal)
Token art	Brother Aldric

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CARAVAN SURVIVOR

A salt-trader, a muleteer, a child wrapped in three coats. Cold, frightened, and alive.

Size 1 · **HP** 5 · **Guard** 7 · **Move** 4

A survivor follows the Guide who leads them and does nothing else. Getting them down the mountain is the point.

PLATFORM ENTRY	
Name	Caravan Survivor
Size	1
Max HP	5
AC	7
Colour	`#8a7a5a`
Attacks	**Struggle** — to-hit `2d6+0`, damage `1d4+0`
Token art	Survivor

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BOARD PIECES

These aren't creatures, but they're tokens, and their HP bar does the work.

TOKEN	SIZE	HP / MAX HP	HIDDEN?	ART	USE
Warmth	1	10 / 10	no	Warmth	the party's shared heat (rules §7); 12 with a Hauler
Storm Clock	1	0 / 6	**yes**	Storm Clock	the GM's weather clock (rules §7)
Cairn	1	—	no	Cairn (fallen) → Cairn (raised)	change the image when it's raised (rules §5.4)